> everything positive which was achieved at the cost of great effort by previous American administrations in the relations between our countries. Today, unfortunately, little remains of the reciprocal positive political gains which were achieved earlier. . . . One cannot help but notice that the general tone of your letter is not the way in which leaders of such powers as the Soviet Union and the United States should talk with each other, especially considering their power and position in the world and their responsibility for the state of international affairs. That is our opinion.

What a good Christmas present, I thought: I'd made my point to Brezhnev.

In a Christmas Day reply to him, I told Brezhnev we would not intervene in Poland if the Russians did not, and proposed that the Polish people only be given the right of self-determination that had been promised to them by Joseph Stalin himself at the Yalta Conference. At Yalta, I reminded him, Stalin had promised Poland and all the countries of Eastern Europe the right of self-determination, but the Soviets had never granted it to any of them.

Shortly before New Year's Day, we backed up our words with action: I announced that we were imposing sanctions against Poland and the Soviet Union in an expression of our displeasure over the crushing of human rights in Poland. We suspended negotiations on a new long-term grain-sale agreement; banned flights to the United States by the Soviet airline, Aeroflot; canceled several exchange programs; and imposed an embargo on shipment to the Soviet Union of critical American-made products, including pipe-laying equipment that was to be used in the construction of a trans-Siberian gas pipeline. When I sought the support of our European allies for this policy, I was disappointed. They agreed we should send a signal of disapproval to the Russians, but not if it involved halting